Sources

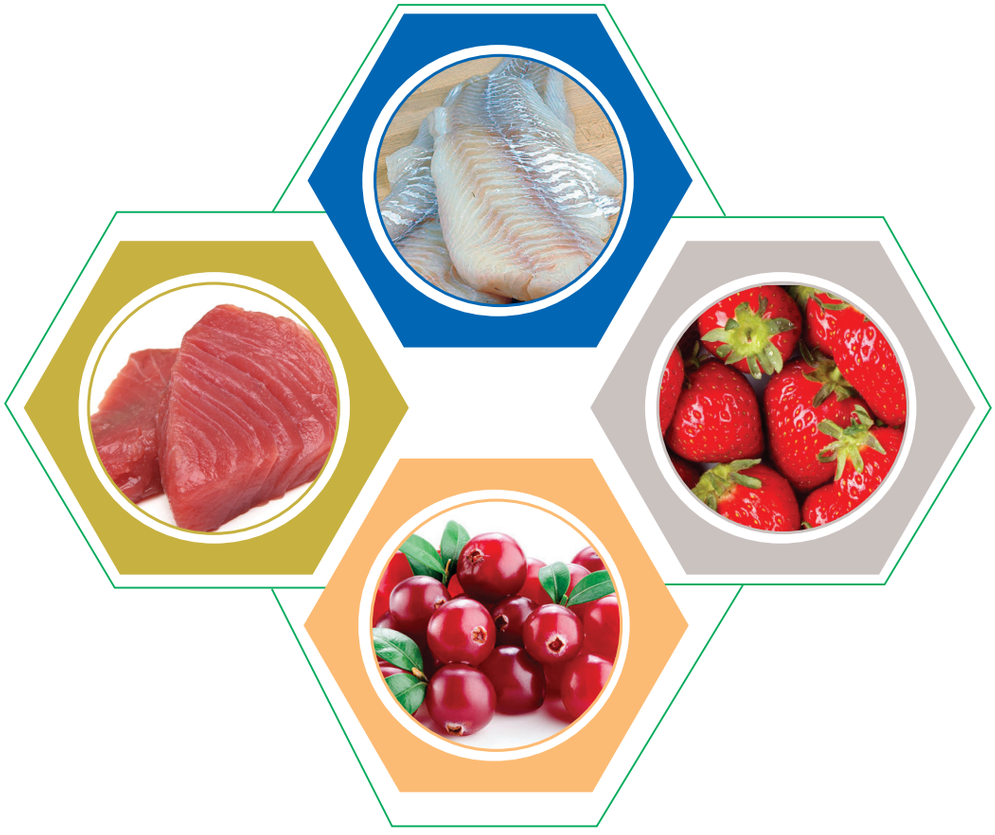


Figure 9.15 Sources of Iodine

Sea water is rich source ofIodine. Vegetables grown in Iodine-rich soil will naturally be the good sources of iodine. Animal sources of iodine include milk, sea fish and crabs.

Absorption and excretion

Absorption is through the villi of the small intestine into the blood stream and 90 % of the iodine of the thyroid gland is in organic combination and stored in the follicular colloids as thyroglobulin.

Inorganic Iodine is mostly excreted by the kidney. Milk of lactating women also contains some iodine.

Deficiency

A deficiency of iodine leads to a decreased production of thyroxine, and in turn a lowered rate of energy metabolism. In an attempt to produce more thyroid hormones the thyroid gland enlarges. This condition is called simple or endemic goiter.

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